

1. Computer based Presentation The availability of affordable software and new technology has made computer based presentations the visual aid of choice in most business situations. What used to take weeks of preparation and an outside production house can now be created by you at your desktop. Computer-based presentations can be real-time or prepared in advance. Real-time presenting is useful when the audience needs to see immediate results or the software in action--like financial brainstorming sessions or software training. Prepared presentations can be simple text slides or--with the integration of text, graphics, animation, video, and sound--sophisticated multimedia productions. Communication Skills – MCM 301 VU © Copyright Virtual University of Pakistan 90 In the past, these sophisticated presentations could only be viewed directly from the monitor or projected in a room equipped with a data/video projector and technical support. With the development of portable data/video projectors these presentations can now be transported and projected almost anywhere. Computer-based presentations bring a level of professionalism that challenges you to be as dynamic as the presentation. With this in mind, it is very important to balance animation, video, transitions and special effects with what you're trying to communicate. Your goal should be a smooth natural delivery of information where the electronics and special effects are not apparent to your audience. Because multimedia software programs provide so many options, it is very easy to overdo them. Beware of creating more interest in the software than the material you're presenting.

Benefits

- Dynamic, full-color multimedia presentations are available to the average presenter
- Data can be presented in real time
- Supply costs are non-existent
- Last minute changes are possible
- Special effects add interest
- Production costs are low
- Transmission to remote locations is possible

Limitations:

- Projection equipment is expensive
- Computer and graphic skills are required
- Presentation depends more upon equipment than the presenter
- A darkened room is required

Helpful Hints:

- Before your presentation check equipment for proper location and function.
- Use only a high-intensity overhead projector
- Use a remote control device to advance your visuals
- If you do not have a remote, have an assistant advance the visuals
- Back up your computer media and take an extra copy with you
- Unless you take your own computer, use the view or runtime version on your computer software program so you do not have to load your software to the computer
- Use a laser pointer to focus the audience's attention
- If possible, vary the presentation with another activity so that you can turn the lights on